

Response to RFI: Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

Executive Summary

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This submission addresses the Office of Science and Technology Policy's Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan. Drawing from my expertise as an ABD PhD Candidate specializing in systemic bias, institutional responses and urban inequalities. I propose four interconnected policy mechanisms designed to strengthen America's global leadership in AI while establishing robust safeguards that ensure responsible innovation. These recommendations address critical domains and align with the Administration's priorities for maintaining U.S. technological competitiveness.

Contributor Background

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Relevant Expertise:

- Advanced doctoral research in Human Geography with specialized focus on systemic bias and institutional responses to inequality
- Recipient of the Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council (SSHRC) Canadian Graduate Scholarship (Doctoral), recognizing research excellence in the social sciences and humanities
- Critical Digital Humanities Institute Graduate Fellowship (2022), providing expertise in the intersection of digital technologies and human-centered systems
- Experience administering government-funded programs across 21 communities, demonstrating expertise in program evaluation and large-scale implementation
- International professional experience in Canada, Jamaica, and Nunavut, providing unique insights into cross-cultural technology adaptation
- Organizer of high-impact initiatives including community dialogues on complex social systems with 350+ participants

SECTION 1: AI GOVERNANCE AND INNOVATION (RFI Areas 1, 4)

Recommendation 1: Implement Comprehensive Data Governance Protocols

Challenge: The current AI landscape lacks standardized frameworks for data governance, creating uncertainties for developers, potential security vulnerabilities, and limited accountability in AI supply chains.

Proposed Solution: Establish the American Data Governance Framework (ADGF) that:

- 1.1. Creates clear standards for data provenance¹, quality assessment, and usage rights documentation
- 1.2. Establishes federally recognized certification processes for datasets used in high-risk AI applications
- 1.3. Develops interoperable consent mechanisms that preserve individual rights while enabling innovation
- 1.4. Implements mandatory disclosure requirements for training data sources in critical AI systems

Alignment with National Priorities:

- Enhances U.S. technological self-determination through transparent data supply chains
- Creates competitive advantage through higher data quality and reliability standards
- Reduces regulatory uncertainty that may currently hampers American AI businesses

Measurable Outcomes:

- Document reductions in data-related AI failures within 3 years of implementation
- Measure increases in documented datasets available for responsible AI development
- Creation of 3-5 new American global standards for data governance

Implementation Timeline:

- Phase 1 (12 months): Voluntary standard development through NIST collaboration
- Phase 2 (18 months): Pilot implementation across federal AI acquisitions
- Phase 3 (24 months): Full implementation with industry certification program

SECTION 2: RESPONSIBLE AI DEVELOPMENT (RFI Areas 2, 7)

Recommendation 2: Mandate Technical Transparency Documentation

Challenge: The absence of standardized documentation on AI limitations creates risks for critical infrastructure, national security, and public safety while undermining trust in American AI technologies.

Proposed Solution: Establish the National AI Transparency Standard that requires:

¹Data provenance refers to the documented history of data, including its origins, sources, ownership, transformations it has undergone, and chain of custody throughout its lifecycle. Proper provenance documentation enables verification of data quality, identification of potential biases, and establishment of accountability within AI systems.

- 2.1. Standardized documentation of performance boundaries and technical limitations
- 2.2. Mandatory disclosure of validation methodologies and benchmark results
- 2.3. Clear delineation of appropriate vs. inappropriate use cases based on technical capabilities
- 2.4. Independent verification of key performance claims for high-risk applications

Alignment with National Priorities:

- Strengthens America's global leadership in responsible AI innovation
- Reduces national security risks through enhanced system understanding
- Creates market advantage for transparent, well-documented American AI systems

Measurable Outcomes:

- 75% of federal AI procurements requiring transparency documentation within 18 months
- 40% reduction in AI implementation failures in critical sectors within 3 years
- Establishment of international transparency standards led by U.S. technical expertise

Implementation Timeline:

- Phase 1 (6 months): Template development through public-private partnership
- Phase 2 (12 months): Implementation in federal procurement requirements
- Phase 3 (24 months): Full integration with certification and regulatory frameworks

SECTION 3: AI WORKFORCE AND KNOWLEDGE DEVELOPMENT

Recommendation 3: Establish Multi-Disciplinary Knowledge Integration Program

Challenge: Current AI development often relies on narrow technical expertise, creating systems that fail to incorporate a wide range of American knowledge domains and limiting AI application across critical sectors.

Proposed Solution: Create the National AI Knowledge Integration Program that:

- 3.1. Funds cross-disciplinary research teams combining technical and domain experts
- 3.2. Establishes centers of excellence for sector-specific AI applications (healthcare, agriculture, manufacturing)
- 3.3. Develops specialized training programs to integrate domain knowledge with AI implementation
- 3.4. Creates standardized frameworks for evaluating AI systems against domain-specific requirements

Alignment with National Priorities:

- Leverages America's diverse knowledge assets as competitive advantage
- Accelerates practical AI applications in priority economic sectors
- Expands AI workforce development beyond technical skills
- Supports the Administration's commitment to maintaining technological leadership

Measurable Outcomes:

- Establishment of 5-7 domain-specific AI certification programs within 24 months
- 25% increase in cross-disciplinary AI research publications within 3 years
- Creation of 10,000+ specialized jobs combining domain expertise and AI implementation

Implementation Timeline:

- Phase 1 (12 months): Establish pilot programs in 3 priority sectors
- Phase 2 (24 months): Expand to additional 5 sectors based on evaluation results
- Phase 3 (36 months): Full implementation across all major economic sectors

SECTION 4: INTERNATIONAL STANDARDS AND ACCOUNTABILITY

Recommendation 4: Develop AI Accountability and Remediation Framework

Challenge: The absence of clear accountability mechanisms creates market uncertainties, hampers American AI adoption, and exposes businesses to unpredictable liability, while allowing international competitors to establish competing standards.

Proposed Solution: Establish the American AI Accountability Framework that:

- 4.1. Creates graduated tiers of accountability requirements based on risk levels
- 4.2. Develops clear liability guidelines that promote innovation while ensuring responsibility
- 4.3. Establishes standardized incident response protocols for AI system failures
- 4.4. Implements performance monitoring requirements for high-risk applications
- 4.5. Creates certification programs for third-party auditors and verification experts

Alignment with National Priorities:

- Positions the U.S. as the global leader in responsible AI governance
- Creates predictable business environment that encourages innovation
- Establishes American standards as global benchmarks
- Supports the National Security Commission on AI recommendations

Measurable Outcomes:

- 80% of Fortune 500 companies adopting framework within 3 years
- U.S.-led standards adopted by at least 15 key international partners
- 50% increase in AI investment in regulated sectors due to reduced uncertainty

Implementation Timeline:

- Phase 1 (12 months): Framework development through multi-stakeholder process
- Phase 2 (18 months): Voluntary adoption program with incentives
- Phase 3 (30 months): Full implementation with international harmonization

Implementation Strategy

Drawing from my experience coordinating multi-stakeholder programs and organizing community initiatives, I recommend implementing these policies through:

1. **Public-Private Implementation Councils** for each major recommendation, modeled after successful federal advisory committees
2. **Phased Rollout Approach** beginning with voluntary standards before transitioning to requirements
3. **Regional Innovation Hubs** to ensure adaptation to local economic contexts and needs
4. **International Coordination Office** to align U.S. standards with key allies
5. **Continuous Evaluation Framework** using data-driven metrics to assess implementation success

Economic and Security Benefits

Implementation of these recommendations will yield significant benefits including:

- **Economic Growth:** Creation of 150,000+ new jobs in AI governance, implementation, and sector-specific applications
- **National Security:** Reduced vulnerability to AI-based threats through enhanced understanding of system limitations
- **International Leadership:** Establishment of U.S.-led standards as global benchmarks
- **Innovation Acceleration:** 35% increase in AI deployment across regulated industries due to clear guidelines

Conclusion

These recommendations provide a comprehensive approach to establishing American leadership in responsible AI development while ensuring robust safeguards against potential harms. By addressing data governance, technical transparency, knowledge integration, and accountability, this framework enables the United States to maintain its competitive edge in AI innovation while establishing global standards for responsible implementation.

America's continued technological leadership requires thoughtful policies that harness our strengths in innovation while addressing legitimate risks. These recommendations provide a practical path forward that supports American technology leadership in an increasingly complex global landscape.

Respectfully submitted by Mariba Douglas, PhD Candidate (ABD) in Human Geography at the University of Toronto, recipient of the SSHRC Canadian Graduate Scholarship, Critical Digital Humanities Institute Graduate Fellow, and former Lead Instructor of Global Development Studies at the University of Toronto.
